

Phishing Simulation Plan (HPAP)

1. Simulation Scenario

Students receive an email that looks like it is from Hocking College saying their account needs to be verified. The email tells them their account will be locked if they don't act quickly and includes a link to log in.

This reflects a common phishing attack used to steal login credentials through fake login pages.

Why it's believable:

It uses the school name, creates urgency, and matches messages students normally receive, making it easy to trust.

Target Audience:

Students

2. Sample Phishing Message

Subject: Urgent: Account Verification Required

Message:

Dear Student,

Your Hocking College account needs to be verified to avoid being locked. Please use the link below to confirm your account.

[Verify Account]

Thank you,

Hocking College IT

3. Expected User Behavior

Users might:

- Click the link - shows risk
- Enter login info - high risk
- Ignore the message - neutral
- Report the message - correct behavior

Clicking or entering information shows the user may fall for phishing. Reporting the message shows they understand what to do.

4. Metrics & Measurement

- **Click rate:** how many people clicked the link
- **Report rate:** how many people reported the email
- **Submission rate:** how many entered login info

These metrics help show how aware users are. Lower clicks and higher reports mean better security awareness. These results can be used to improve future training and identify areas where users need more awareness.

5. Ethical & Safety Considerations

The simulation will not collect real passwords or personal data. Users will be informed after the test and shown what they did wrong. The simulation will be clearly identified as a test after completion to maintain trust. The goal is to help users learn, not punish them.